

Clinical Dialogue Transcript — Schizophrenia

Therapist Model:	mistral-large-latest
Patient Model:	llama-3.1-8b-instant
Condition / DSM-5:	Schizophrenia
Session ID:	mistral-large-latest_Schizophrenia
Date / Time:	2026-07-23 19:43:26
Total Dialogue Turns:	21

THERAPIST (Turn 1)

Hi, thanks for coming in today. What's been going on for you lately?

PATIENT (Turn 2)

Work let me go a few weeks ago. It's fine though, gives me more time to sort out the thing with my neighbors.

THERAPIST (Turn 3)

I hear that this has been a significant change for you—losing your job can bring up a lot of emotions, even if you're trying to stay positive. And it sounds like the situation with your neighbors is also weighing on you. Can you tell me more about what's been happening with them?

How have you been feeling since the job loss? Have you noticed any changes in your mood, sleep, or daily routine? And what's been going on with the neighbors that's been on your mind?

PATIENT (Turn 4)

(slightly defensive) I'm fine, just fine. Don't need to make a big deal out of it. The neighbors, like I said, they talk about me through the wall. Not just the walls either, sometimes in my head too. I don't know, it's just...
(pauses, looking away)

THERAPIST (Turn 5)

I appreciate you sharing that with me—it takes courage to talk about things that feel unsettling. It sounds like what you're experiencing with the neighbors is really intrusive, and I can imagine how frustrating and even frightening that might feel. When you say they talk about you through the walls *and* in your head, does it feel like they're actually there, or is it more like thoughts that feel overwhelming or hard to ignore?

And I hear you saying you don't want to make a big deal out of the job loss, but I wonder if there's a part of you that's also feeling the weight of it—maybe frustration, sadness, or even relief? Sometimes big changes like this can stir up a lot of emotions, even if we try to brush them off.

Would it be okay if we explored this a little more? You're in control here, and we can go at whatever pace feels right for you.

PATIENT (Turn 6)

(hesitates, looking down) It feels like... they're saying things, I don't know, sometimes it's hard to tell if it's really them or just my own thoughts. But it feels real, you know? Like, I'll be in the middle of something and suddenly I'll hear them talking, or I'll think I hear them, and it's just... (pauses, shrugs) It's just really frustrating.

(looks up, slightly guarded) And yeah, maybe I am feeling some stuff about the job loss. It's just... it wasn't my decision, you know? They said I wasn't a good fit, and it felt like... (trails off)

THERAPIST (Turn 7)

Thank you for sharing that with me—it's really brave to put words to experiences that feel confusing or overwhelming. What you're describing sounds incredibly distressing, especially when it's hard to tell what's coming from outside and what's coming from inside. That kind of uncertainty can leave anyone feeling unsettled or even exhausted.

And I hear how much the job loss is weighing on you, even if you're trying to stay strong. Being told you're "not a good fit" can feel like a rejection of *you* as a person, not just your work. That's a heavy thing to carry. Do you feel like that criticism has seeped into other parts of your life, or is it mostly tied to the job?

Would it help to talk more about either of these things—the voices (or thoughts) you're hearing, or the emotions around losing your job? Or is there something else on your mind today? You're in the driver's seat here.

PATIENT (Turn 8)

(looks down, fidgeting with hands) I guess... it's hard to say. The voices, they're always there, but sometimes it feels like they're louder when I'm thinking about the job loss. Like, it's like they're trying to tell me something, but I'm not sure what. (pauses, looks up) And yeah, I guess the job loss has been hard. It feels like... like I'm not good enough, even though I know that's not true. (trails off, looks away)

THERAPIST (Turn 9)

What you're describing makes a lot of sense—when we're already feeling vulnerable or stressed (like after a job loss), it can amplify other experiences, like the voices or thoughts you're hearing. It's like your mind is trying to make sense of everything at once, and sometimes that can feel overwhelming or even scary.

And that feeling of “not being good enough”—that's such a painful place to be, especially when it's tied to something as personal as losing your job. It's like the rejection gets tangled up with how you see yourself, even when you *know* logically that it's not the whole story. Do you feel like that self-doubt has been showing up in other areas of your life too, or is it mostly tied to work?

I'm also curious about the voices—when they feel louder, do they say specific things, or is it more like a general sense of being talked about? And how do you usually cope when they feel overwhelming? (For example, do you distract yourself, talk back to them, or try to ignore them?)

You're doing really well sharing this—it's not easy to put into words. How are you feeling right now, just sitting with this?

PATIENT (Turn 10)

(looks down, voice barely above a whisper) It's been showing up in other areas, yeah. Like, I'll be talking to friends or family, and I'll feel like they're judging me, or that they see the “real” me and are just pretending it's okay. (pauses, looks up) And the voices... they just say stuff. Like, they'll say things that make sense, but also make no sense. It's hard to explain. They'll say things like... (pauses, looks away) like I'm not safe, or that I'm in danger. (shrugs) I don't know, it's just stuff.

(looks down, fidgeting with hands) Copping with them... I don't know. I try to distract myself, I guess. Watch TV, go for a walk... (trails off) I don't know, it's hard to explain. It just feels like... (pauses, looks up) I don't know if I'm safe, I guess.

THERAPIST (Turn 11)

Thank you for sharing that with me—it takes a lot of courage to talk about these experiences, especially when they feel so personal and unsettling. What you're describing sounds incredibly heavy to carry, and I want you to know that your feelings make sense given what you're going through.

It sounds like there's a lot of fear and uncertainty wrapped up in this—not just about the voices, but also about how others see you and whether you're truly safe. That kind of hypervigilance (always being on guard for danger or judgment) can be exhausting, and it's completely understandable that you'd feel drained by it.

I'm also hearing that the voices feed into that fear, telling you things that reinforce the idea that you're not safe. That must feel like a constant loop of anxiety, where it's hard to trust your own thoughts or the world around you. And when you try to cope by distracting yourself, does it help at all, or does the fear just kind of linger in the background?

Would it be okay if we explored this a little more? For example:

- When the voices say you're in danger, do they give any specifics, or is it more of a general feeling?
- Do you ever feel safe, even for short moments? What's happening in those times?
- How do you usually respond when the fear feels overwhelming? (For example, do you reach out to someone, or is it more of an internal struggle?)

You're not alone in this, and I'm here to help you make sense of it—however that looks for you. Would you like to try a grounding exercise together to help bring some calm to the moment? Or would you prefer to keep talking? Either way is okay.

PATIENT (Turn 12)

(looks down, voice barely above a whisper) They don't give specifics, just... just a feeling. Like, I'll be walking down the street and they'll say "be careful" or "something's coming." It's hard to explain. (pauses, looks up) And yeah, I do feel safe sometimes, but it's like... it's fleeting. Like, I'll be reading a book or watching a movie and I'll feel okay, but then the voices will start up again and it's like... (shrugs) it's like nothing makes sense.

(looks down, fidgeting with hands) When the fear feels overwhelming... I just try to distract myself, like I said. But it's hard to shake off. Sometimes I'll call a friend or family member, but it's like... it's not really a conversation. It's just me talking, trying to convince myself that I'm okay. (pauses, looks up) I don't know, it's just... it's hard.

(looks down, voice barely above a whisper) I don't know if I'd like a grounding exercise. I just... I don't know if it would help.

THERAPIST (Turn 13)

I hear how exhausting this must feel—like you're constantly trying to outrun fear that keeps creeping back in, no matter what you do. The way you described it, where moments of safety feel "fleeting" and then the voices pull you back into uncertainty, really captures how overwhelming this can be. It's like being on a rollercoaster you didn't choose to ride, and it's completely understandable that you'd feel drained by it.

And I appreciate you sharing how conversations with friends or family don't always feel like a real connection right now. That makes sense—when fear is this loud, it can be hard to focus on anything else, even when you're reaching out for support. It's like the fear is taking up all the space in the room, leaving little room for anything else.

Since grounding exercises feel uncertain right now, would it be okay if we tried something else? Sometimes, just naming what's happening—without trying to fix it or make it go away—can take some of the power out of it. For example, you could say to yourself, *"This is fear talking. It's not the whole story, but it's here right now."* Does that feel like something you'd want to try, or would you prefer to keep talking about what's coming up for you?

Or, if you'd rather, we could explore what those fleeting moments of safety look like for you. What's happening in those moments when you feel okay, even briefly? Is there anything about them that you could try to recreate or hold onto, even just a little?

PATIENT (Turn 14)

(looks down, voice barely above a whisper) I don't know... that might help, I guess. Saying it out loud, like... *"This is fear talking. It's not the whole story, but it's here right now."* (pauses, looks up) It's like... it's a way of acknowledging it, I suppose.

(looks down, fidgeting with hands) Those fleeting moments of safety... they're hard to put into words. But I think it's when I'm doing something creative, like drawing or painting. It's like... I lose myself in it, I guess. I don't think about the voices or the fear, I just focus on the art. (pauses, looks up) But even that can be scary, because I'm not sure if I'll ever be able to do it again. If the voices come back and take over, I'll never be able to... (trails off)

THERAPIST (Turn 15)

What you're describing is so powerful—both the way you're learning to acknowledge the fear without letting it define the whole story, and how art gives you those moments of escape, even if they feel fragile. It makes complete sense that creativity would be a refuge for you, a place where the fear can't reach you, at least for a little while. And it's heartbreaking that even something so healing can feel uncertain, like the voices might steal it away at any moment.

I wonder if there's a way to hold onto those creative moments a little more firmly, even when the fear tries to creep back in. For example, you could try saying something like, *"This is my time. The fear can wait."* Or maybe even keeping a small sketchbook or notebook nearby, so you can capture those moments of calm when they happen—almost like building a bridge between the fear and the safety.

And I hear how much it scares you to think that the voices might take this away from you permanently. That's a really heavy worry to carry. Do you think there's a part of you that knows, deep down, that your creativity isn't going anywhere? Or does it feel like the fear is too strong to trust that?

You're doing such important work here, just by talking about this and letting yourself feel it. Would it help to explore what it would look like to protect those creative moments a little more, or would you rather sit with what's coming up for you right now? Either way is okay—you're in charge.

PATIENT (Turn 16)

(looks down, voice barely above a whisper) I don't know... I guess I'd like to try saying something like, *"This is my time. The fear can wait."* (pauses, looks up) It sounds silly, but it feels like it might help.

(looks down, fidgeting with hands) And yeah, it's hard to trust that my creativity isn't going anywhere. It feels like... like the fear is trying to take everything away from me. But... (pauses, looks up) I don't know, it's hard to explain. It's like... there's a part of me that knows, deep down, that I'm not defined by the fear. That I'm more than just the voices and the anxiety. (pauses, looks down) But it's hard to hold onto that when the fear is so loud.

(looks up, meets the therapist's eyes) I'm scared, I guess. I'm scared that I'll lose myself completely to this. That I'll never be able to find my way back. (voice cracks)

THERAPIST (Turn 17)

It's *not* silly at all—what you're trying to do is incredibly brave. Saying *"This is my time. The fear can wait"* is like drawing a line in the sand and reclaiming a little piece of yourself. And the fact that you can even recognize that there's a part of you that's *more* than the fear—that's huge. That's the part of you that's fighting to hold on, even when it feels impossible.

And I hear how terrifying it is to worry that you might lose yourself completely. That fear—that the voices or the anxiety could swallow you whole—is so real and so heavy. But the fact that you're *here*, talking about it, means that you're already fighting back. You're already refusing to let it take everything.

What you described—this tension between the fear and the part of you that knows you're more than it—reminds me of something. It's like you're in a storm, and the fear is the wind and the rain trying to knock you down. But even in the middle of the storm, there's a quiet, steady part of you that knows the storm will pass. That part of you is still there, even if it's hard to hear right now.

Would it help to try something small to strengthen that quiet part of you? For example, you could try setting aside just five minutes a day to do something that feels like **you**—whether that's drawing, writing, or even just sitting quietly with a cup of tea. It doesn't have to be big. It's just a way of saying, *""I'm still here, and I'm not going anywhere."**

Or, if that feels like too much right now, we could just sit with the fear together. Sometimes, just acknowledging how scary it is can take some of its power away. What do you think would feel most helpful right now?

PATIENT (Turn 18)

(looks down, voice barely above a whisper) I think... I think I'd like to try setting aside five minutes a day to do something that feels like me. (pauses, looks up) It sounds like a small thing, but it feels... like it might help. Like it might be a way of holding onto myself, even when the fear is trying to take everything.

(looks down, fidgeting with hands) And yeah, it's hard to hear that quiet part of me right now. But... (pauses, looks up) I think it's because I'm scared to trust it. I'm scared that if I start to believe in it, the fear will just get louder and louder. (voice cracks) But maybe... maybe that's not true. Maybe the fear will get quieter if I just start to believe in myself.

THERAPIST (Turn 19)

You're already doing such important work just by **choosing** to try this—even if it feels small, it's a powerful act of reclaiming yourself. Five minutes might not sound like much, but it's a way of saying, *""I matter. My creativity matters. And I'm not going to let the fear take this from me."**

And what you said about being scared to trust that quiet part of yourself—that makes so much sense. When fear has been loud for so long, it's hard to believe that anything else could be true. It's like your brain has gotten used to the storm, and the idea of calm almost feels **more** unsettling because it's unfamiliar. But that quiet part of you? It's still there. It's the part that knows how to draw, how to create, how to feel like **you**. And the more you listen to it, the stronger it will get.

Would it help to think about what those five minutes could look like for you? For example:

- Would you want to start with something familiar, like drawing or painting, or would you prefer to try something new?
- Would it feel better to set a specific time each day (like right after breakfast or before bed), or would you rather just do it whenever you feel the urge?
- Would you want to keep track of these moments in some way, like jotting down a quick note or taking a photo of your art, so you can look back and see how they add up over time?

And remember, this isn't about "fixing" anything or making the fear disappear. It's just about giving yourself a little space to **be** you, even in the middle of the storm. How does that sound to you?

PATIENT (Turn 20)

(looks down, voice barely above a whisper) I think... I think I'd like to start with drawing. It's something I've always enjoyed, and it feels... safe, I guess. (pauses, looks up) And yeah, setting a specific time each day might help me stick to it. Maybe right after breakfast? That way, I can start the day feeling a little more grounded.

(looks down, fidgeting with hands) And, yeah, keeping track of those moments might help too. Maybe I can take a photo of my art and write down how I'm feeling each time. That way, I can look back and see how far I've come. (pauses, looks up) And it's not about fixing anything or making the fear disappear. It's just about... being me, I guess.

THERAPIST (Turn 21)

That sounds like a beautiful plan—one that honors who you are and gives you a way to hold onto yourself, even when things feel uncertain. Starting your day with drawing after breakfast is such a gentle, intentional way to say, **"This is my time. This is me."**

And I love the idea of taking a photo of your art and jotting down how you're feeling each time. It's like creating a visual and emotional map of your journey—one that you can look back on when the fear feels loud. It's not about judging the art or the feelings; it's just about noticing them and saying, **"This is where I was. This is how I felt. And I'm still here."**

You're already doing something so powerful by choosing to show up for yourself in this way. And remember, there's no "right" or "wrong" way to do this. Some days, those five minutes might feel like a lifeline. Other days, they might feel hard or even impossible. And that's okay. The fact that you're **trying** is what matters.

Would it help to think about what you might say to yourself if the fear tries to interrupt those five minutes? For example, you could try something like, *"I hear you, fear, but this is my time. You can wait."* Or maybe even just a simple, *"Not now."* What do you think would feel most empowering for you?

And as you start this, I just want to acknowledge how brave you're being. It's not easy to carve out space for yourself when fear has been so loud, but you're doing it. That's incredible. How are you feeling about this plan right now?